shikshagraha

Improving Attendance through Community Partnership



Ramya Kumar

Rampur village, Sitamarhi district, Bihar

Report of Micro Improvement

★ Problem Statement

Many students were unable to attend school regularly due to lack of transport

★ Objective

To improve school attendance by addressing transport challenges faced by students living far from school

★ Action Steps

1. Identified students facing travel difficulties
2. Met with Gram Panchayat members to request local transport support
3. Arranged a shared auto service for children from distant hamlets
4. Coordinated pickup and drop timings to ensure children
5. Assigned a teacher to supervise the pickup point for the first few weeks

★ Impact

Attendance improved from around 68% to over 90%

Improving Attendance Through Shared Transport

Ramya Kumar, the Headmaster of Government Primary School in Rampur village, Sitamarhi district, Bihar, noticed that many students were unable to attend school regularly due to the lack of transport. Some students had to travel 3-5 kilometres to reach school, often on foot, as there were no regular public buses or autos in the area. Parents were busy with daily wage work and couldn't accompany their children every day. To solve this problem, Ramya discussed the issue in the School Management Committee meeting and identified students facing travel difficulties. She then met the Gram Panchayat members and requested local transport support. With their help, a shared auto service was arranged for children from distant hamlets. Parents and the Panchayat shared the cost, with the Panchayat covering fuel once a week and parents contributing a small monthly amount. Teachers coordinated pickup and drop timings to ensure children reached school safely. Initially, parents were hesitant to send children in a shared vehicle, but Ramya overcame this by assigning a teacher to supervise the pickup point for the first few weeks. Once they saw it was safe, everyone was supportive. The solution took around two months to implement, from planning to full implementation. The teachers helped identify students and manage timings, the Gram Panchayat provided local support and a vehicle connection, and parents contributed financially and helped maintain discipline. As a result of this initiative, attendance improved from around 68% to over 90%. Children are now more regular and punctual, and parents feel relieved and more connected to the school. Ramya learned that community partnerships are key to removing barriers to education, and even small steps like arranging shared transport can make a big difference. This experience has shown her the importance of collaboration and community involvement in improving education outcomes.